CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

ORDER NO. 89-171

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
FRANKLIN COUNTY WATER DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MERCED, MERCED COUNTY

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. The Board, on 29 July 1978, adopted Order No. 78-85, which prescribed requirements for a discharge from the Franklin County Water District (hereafter Discharger) domestic wastewater treatment facility to evaporation/percolation ponds.

2. Present waste discharge requirements established by Order No. 78-85 are neither adequate nor consistent with plans and policies of the Board.

3. The facility is approximately 1.5 miles northwest of the City of Merced in Sections 14 and 23, T7S, R13E, MDB&M. The Discharger discharges approximately 0.30 million gallons per day of sewage to an aerated pond, followed by eight (8), evaporation/ percolation ponds totaling 30 acres.

4. Influent flows are currently limited at 0.4 mgd by the size of the influent sewer line and pump station. The District has plans to expand the collection system in the near future. Although the aeration pond is designed to treat a flow of 0.8 mgd, current capacity is limited at 0.6 mgd by the size of the existing percolation/evaporation ponds.

5. Surface water drainage is to Black Rascal Creek which parallels the south boundary of the site. Black Rascal Creek is tributary to Bear Creek, which is tributary to the San Joaquin River, waters of the United States. The beneficial uses of the San Joaquin River, are municipal, domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation, freshwater habitat; fish migration and spawning; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife and other aquatic resources.

6. The beneficial uses of the ground water are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply.

7. Ground water of excellent mineral quality, specific conductance of less than 600 micromhos/cm, is generally encountered at a depth of 20 feet. Ground water flow is to the southwest.

8. Soil in the area is classified as Landow Clay, which is tight and slowly drained.

9. The Board, on 25 July 1975, adopted a Water Quality Control Plan for the San Joaquin River Basin (5C) which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements are consistent with that Plan.

10. The action to update waste discharge requirements for this facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act, in accordance with Section 15301, Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR).

11. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge.

12. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 78-85 be rescinded and the Franklin County Water District, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. **Discharge Prohibitions:**

1. The direct discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.

2. The by-pass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.

3. The discharge of wastes to facilities not adequately maintained to prevent odor nuisance or vector breeding is prohibited.

4. The resurfacing of wastewater percolating from holding ponds is prohibited.

B. **Discharge Specifications:**

1. Neither the treatment nor the discharge shall cause a nuisance or condition of pollution as defined by the California Water Code, Section 13050.

2. The discharge shall not cause degradation of ground or surface waters.

3. The discharge shall remain within the designated disposal area at all times.

4. The 30-day average daily flow shall not exceed 0.40 mgd until such time as the collection system improvements have been implemented. Upon completion of the improvements, the 30-day average daily flow shall not exceed 0.6 mgd.

5. Collected screening, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner approved by the Executive Officer.

6. The dissolved oxygen content of holding ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l for 16 hours in any 24-hour period.

7. A minimum freeboard of one (1) foot shall be maintained in each pond at all times.

8. Public access to the treatment and disposal facilities shall be precluded through a satisfactory combination of signing and/or fencing, or some other equivalent alternative.

C. **Provisions:**

1. The Discharger may be required to submit technical reports as directed by the Executive Officer.

2. The Discharger shall comply with the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program No. **89-171.**

3. The Discharger shall comply with the Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements, dated 1 September 1985, which are a part of this Order.

4. By **31 January 1990**, the Discharger shall provide certified wastewater treatment plant operators in accordance with regulations adopted by the State Water Resources Control Board.

5. The Discharger shall maintain a copy of this Order at the site and make it available at all times to facility operating personnel, who shall be familiar with its contents.

6. Within **90 days** of adoption of this Order, the Discharger will submit a report detailing a plan and time schedule for assessing any impact on ground water from wastewater disposal practices. The report should be prepared by a California registered engineer or certified engineering geologist.

7. Within **30 days** of adoption of this Order, the Discharger will submit a report detailing the District's flow metering system and the methods applied to insure reliable and accurate flow monitoring.

8. Within **six months** of adoption of this Order, the Discharger shall submit a report which details present and future flow projections (minimum 5-year projection) and details how flow volumes will be prevented from exceeding design capacity or how capacity will be increased.

9. Within **six months** of adoption of this Order, the Discharger shall submit the results of a Non-domestic User Survey which will list all users (commercial and industrial) known to be discharging non-domestic waste to the treatment facility. The survey will detail name and type of business, and quantity and type of waste discharged. The list shall be updated annually.

10. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities presently owned or controlled by the Discharger, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be forwarded to this office. The Discharger

shall notify the Board in writing, of any proposed change in the character, volume, or location of the waste discharge. This notification shall be given **180 days** prior to the effective date of the change and shall be accompanied by an amended RWD and any technical documents that are needed to demonstrate continued compliance with these WDRs.

11. The Board will review this Order periodically and may revise requirements when necessary.

I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, on **22 September 1989.**

William H. Crooks

WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

Revised:8/31/89:GDS:gs

CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 89-171

FOR
FRANKLIN COUNTY WATER DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MERCED, MERCED COUNTY

Specific sample station locations shall be established under direction of the Board's staff.

EFFLUENT MONITORING

Effluent samples shall be collected just prior to discharge to the disposal ponds. Effluent samples should be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge. Samples collected from the outlet structure of ponds will be considered adequately composited. Time of collection of a grab sample shall be recorded. The following shall constitute the effluent monitoring program:

Constituents	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling Frequency
Specific Conductivity	µmhos/cm	Grab	Monthly
pH	pH Units	Grab	Monthly
Flow	mgd	Cumulative	Daily
20°C BOD	mg/l	Grab	Quarterly

POND MONITORING

The following shall constitute the monitoring program for each effluent disposal pond:

Measurement	Units	Type of Sample	Minimum Frequency of Analysis
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	Grab	Weekly
Freeboard	feet (in tenths)	Visual	Twice Monthly
Specific Conductance	µmhos/cm	Grab	Quarterly
Sludge Depth	feet	Grab	Annually

In conducting the weekly pond water sampling, a log shall be kept of the pond conditions. The following conditions shall be documented for presence or absence or characterization:

a. Floating or suspended matter
b. Discoloration
c. Odors
d. Bank conditions

SURFACE WATER MONITORING

All receiving water samples shall be grab samples. Receiving water samples shall be taken from the following:

Station	Description
R-1	Black Rascal Creek 100 feet east (upstream) of ponds
R-2	Black Rascal Creek 100 feet southwest (downstream) of ponds

Measurement	Units	Sampling Frequency
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/l	Quarterly
pH	pH Units	Quarterly
Temperature	°F (C°)	Quarterly
Specific Conductance	µmhos/cm	Quarterly
Flow	estimate	Monthly
Nitrate Nitrogen	mg/l	Quarterly
Ammonia Nitrogen	mg/l	Quarterly
Total and Fecal Coliforms	mg/l	Quarterly
Riverbank seepage	Visual	Monthly
Riverbank vegetation	Visual	Monthly
River discoloration	Visual	Monthly

WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

A sampling station shall be established where a representative sample of the municipal water supply can be obtained. The following shall constitute the water supply monitoring program:

Constituents	Units	Sampling Frequency
Specific Conductivity	µmhos/cm @ 25°C	Annually

GROUND WATER MONITORING

A ground water monitoring program will be developed after submittal of the report specified in Provision 6 of this Order.

REPORTING

In reporting the monitoring data, the Discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form so that the date, the constituents, and the concentrations are readily discernible. The data shall be summarized in such a manner to illustrate clearly the compliance with waste discharge requirements.

Monthly monitoring reports shall be submitted to the Regional Board by the **15th day** of the following month.

The results of any monitoring done more frequently than required at the locations specified in the Monitoring and Reporting Program shall be reported to the Board.

The Discharger shall submit a report to the Board by **30 January** of each year. The report shall contain both tabular and graphical summaries of the monitoring data obtained during the previous year. The report should discuss all significant aspects of the previous year's operation and projections for the current year. In addition, the Discharger shall discuss the compliance record and the corrective actions taken or planned which may be needed to bring the discharge into full compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

The Discharger shall implement the above monitoring program as of the date of this Order.

William H. Crooks

WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

22 September 1989

(Date)

Revised:8/31/89:GDS:gs

INFORMATION SHEET

FRANKLIN COUNTY WATER DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MERCED, MERCED COUNTY

This is an existing municipal wastewater treatment facility. Waste discharge requirements were first set forth in Resolution No. 61-162, adopted 14 December 1961, and revised in Resolution No. 78-85, adopted 29 July 1978.

The facility is on the east side of Drake Avenue and north side of Black Rascal Creek in Sections 14 and 23, T7S, R13E, MDB&M.

The facility consists of an aerated lagoon followed by eight (8) stabilization ponds. Present flow is approximately 0.3 mgd.

The 30-day average daily flow shall not exceed 0.40 mgd until such time as the collection system improvements have been implemented. Upon completion of the improvements, the 30-day average daily flow shall not exceed 0.6 mgd.

Soils in the area are Landlow Clay, which are rather dense and slowly drained. Ground water in the area occurs at a depth of about 20 feet. It is of excellent quality with a specific conductance of less than 600 micromhos/cm. Surface drainage is to Black Rascal Creek, which is tributary to Bear Creek.

Black Rascal Creek enters Bear Creek about 0.25 miles south of the facility by way of an irrigation canal. Bear Creek continues for about 0.5 miles west to the Crocker Dam where flows can be diverted to either the natural drainage course of Black Rascal Creek or continue down Bear Creek. Black Rascal Creek reenters Bear Creek some five miles southwest of the Crocker Dam. Bear Creek continues for about eight miles to its junction with the Eastside Canal. At this point, water from Bear Creek is distributed to a system of natural and man-made irrigation and drainage channels (branches of the Eastside Canal and the Eastside Bypass: Deep Slough, Bear Creek Bravel Slough), with general drainage to the San Joaquin River. Water in Black Rascal and Bear Creeks and the network of downstream drainage channels is used primarily for agricultural supply (irrigation and stock watering) and wildlife habitat (water fowl areas, marshland, and duck ponds). Flows in these drainage courses are highly variable and dependent to a great extent upon irrigation practices.

These requirements are being updated to reflect the present plans and policies of the Regional Board. A surface water monitoring program of Black Rascal Creek is being implemented due to the proximity of the disposal ponds.

The action to update waste discharge requirements is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act, in accordance with Section 15301, Title 14, California Code of Regulations.

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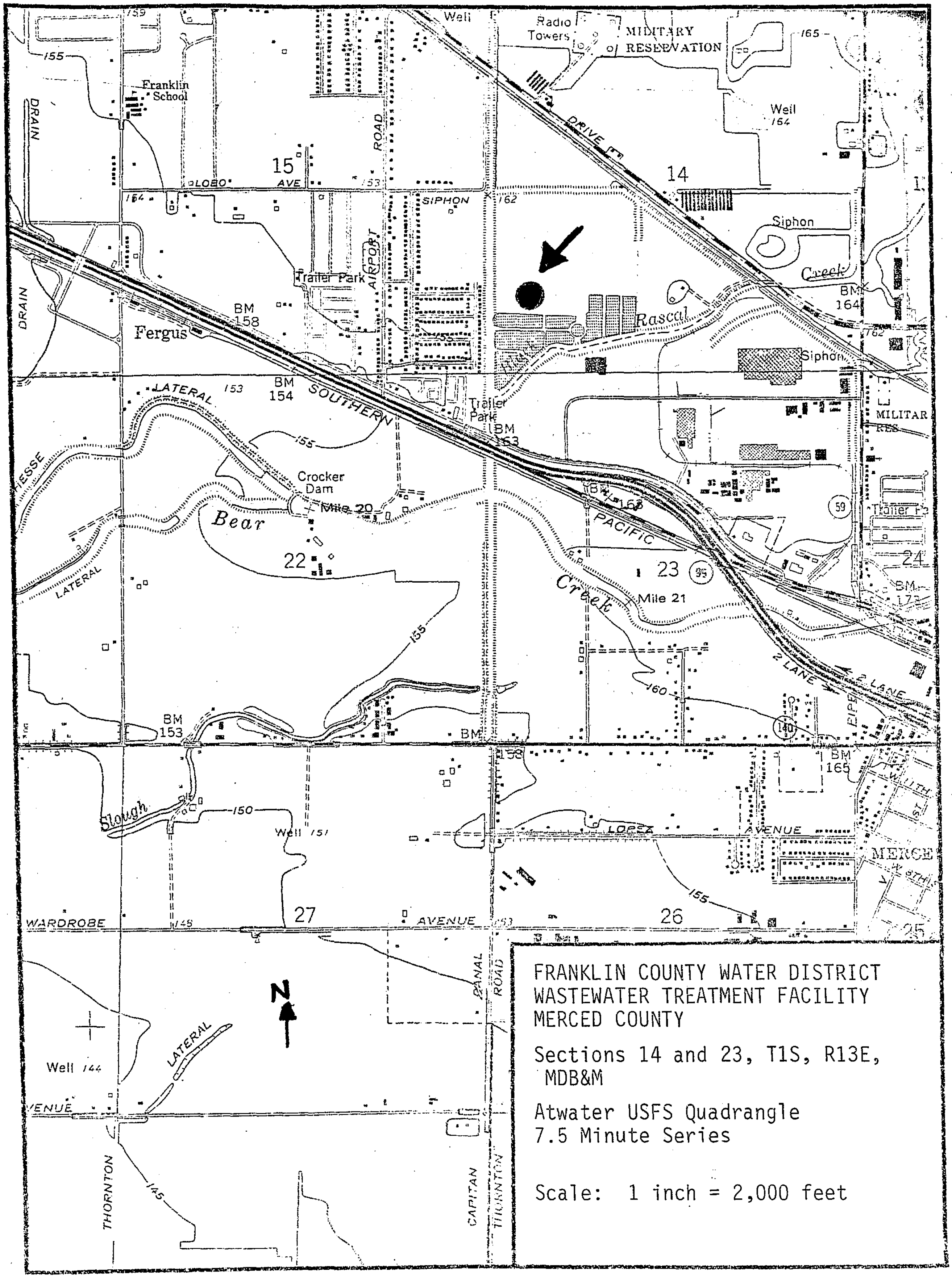

FRANKLIN COUNTY WATER DISTRICT
WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY
MERCED COUNTY

Sections 14 and 23, T1S, R13E, MDB&M

Atwater USFS Quadrangle
7.5 Minute Series

Scale: 1 inch = 2,000 feet